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Q You spoke about a time when the PC was a key driver of Digital Transformation, and from there on, it evolved to the server, the cloud and now, the Intelligent Edge. Don't you think the smartphone is still a key driver of Digital Transformation in India? If so, how is Microsoft a part of the Indian mobile user's experience, compared to the way Google has become a daily driver of most smartphone users?

Anant: I would agree with you that the mobile phone revolution has been a critical driver of digital transformation. Three years back, Microsoft was amongst the first companies to say that we are living in a mobile first, cloud first world.

What has happened over the last three years is that I think we moved on from the mobile being the primary intelligent edge to many other capabilities of many other edge devices coming into play. So, mobile continues to play an important role in edge devices, but there are many, many more and that's why I think the narrative is about the intelligent edge and the intelligent cloud. But, the word 'intelligent' is also very critical over there because artificial intelligence is playing a critical part both in the cloud and on the edge devices.

Secondly, how is Microsoft a critical partner or player in the mobile revolution...I'll just take my iPhone out and I would say - Listen, when I work on a daily basis on Office 365, I seamlessly work between my Surface, which

is a Microsoft device and an iOS device, and similarly for all Android phones. So, I think the world is very different today where the OS may not necessarily be the driver.

Q Aren't you currently seeing a demand for products like the Surface Book here in India?

Anant: There's of course a demand. But, Microsoft is not just about our first party products. Microsoft is also, (for) a large part, on the partnerships that we have through our OEM partners like HP and Dell and many others. A lot of these players are bringing some cutting edge products into the market already. We are satisfying that demand through one channel or the other for now.

Q Something you touched upon in your keynote at the Microsoft conference in Hyderabad was gaming. It seems like Microsoft has lost interest in bringing its gaming portfolio of products to India. The Xbox used to be a well marketed console in India at one point of time, with Akshay Kumar as the brand ambassador. The company's approach to gaming in India seems to have taken a back seat. Why is that so?

Anant: It (Gaming) remains one of the key focus areas. It's one of the five core solution areas that we drive globally and in India also. The big shift in the gaming industry globally has been towards on-line gaming capabilities, rather than pure play hardware. Therefore, I think that's the big shift that's happening across the world and Microsoft continues to play a significant role here.

Q But, the Microsoft Xbox One S was launched in India almost a year after its international launch. That says something. Is this how Microsoft plans to introduce the Xbox One X in India as well, a year later?

Anant: I would not take any continuation of trend lines from what has happened in the past to the future. It highly depends on what the offering is and what the opportunity for that offering is in the market, and if it makes sense for it to economically have it available and at what point. As soon as we have very clear messaging to share on that one (the launch of the Xbox One X) we will. 